



HAIR GRIPPERS

With their flattened bodies and sharp, grasping claws, tiny head lice crawl through hair, piercing the scalp to suck blood. Between feeds they grip hairs, making it difficult to wash or comb them away. The wingless insects live for about 30 days. They mainly infect children and are passed on when heads touch.

A head louse relies on its two sensitive feelers (antennae) to detect movement and to smell.

The legs end in sharp, curved claws that are perfect for grasping hairs, preventing the louse from being dislodged.

A head louse egg, called a nit, is glued firmly to a scalp hair. A female head louse can lay up to 10 eggs a day.

WOW!

If thousands of skin bacteria can fit onto the period at the end of this sentence, imagine how many are living on your skin.

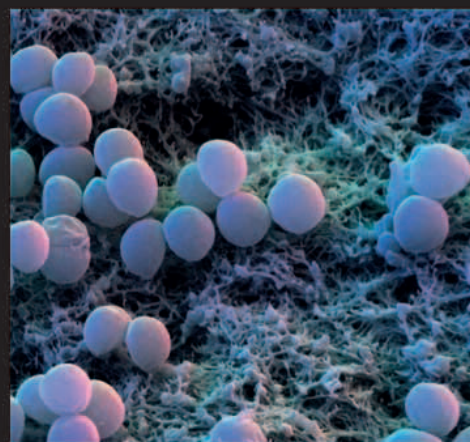


BURROWING MITES

Eyelash mites are wormlike creatures that live head downward inside the eyelash follicles. Here they feast on oily sebum and dead skin cells. You cannot see or feel them, and they are often harmless. They emerge from their human homes at night and wander over the skin, as can be seen in this magnified view.

FRIENDLY GERMS

Millions of germs, such as these ball-shaped skin bacteria called *Staphylococcus* (meaning “bunches of grapes”) live on your body, favoring damper, warmer places such as armpits. Many deter other harmful bacteria from settling on your body’s surface. But if the skin is cut, bacteria can get inside the body, multiply rapidly, and cause infection.



BED CRAWLERS

Wingless bedbugs find their victims by detecting body warmth. Most active at night, they emerge from their hiding places, pierce the skin of sleeping victims, and feed on blood, leaving itchy rashes and bite marks. After feeding for about five minutes, the blood-swollen bugs scurry back to their hiding places to digest their meal.

Bedbugs have flattened, oval bodies with three pairs of curved legs.

